



Modern telephony owes a lot to Dr. Erna Hoover

Argus, a programming language – largely an extension of the original CLU, that was meant for distributed program executions across multiple computers on a network (today's distributed computing). Liskov also created an object-oriented database system called 'Thor'.

If it weren't for Liskov's rare genius and her crucial advances in object-oriented programming, the computing world would've been deprived of concepts that led to a smorgasbord of modern OOP-based languages and operating systems, such as Java, Objective-C, C++, Visual Basic.NET and Mac OS X, among others. In 2008, Liskov was bestowed with the Turing Award for "contributions to practical and theoretical foundations of programming language and system design, especially related to data abstraction, fault tolerance and distributed computing." Well deserved!

DIVA OF GAMING

The world of computer games would've been fairly desolate and mundane if it weren't for the efforts of Roberta Williams, an American game designer born in 1953. She has been credited with developing the concept of logic-based graphical adventure gaming. Here's how...

Best known for creating the adventure game series *King's Quest*, which had as many as eight sequels, Roberta Williams is hailed for pioneering, creating

and popularising this small but rapidly expanding corner of PC games. With her husband, Ken Williams, she co-founded 'Sierra On-Line' (later known as 'Sierra Entertainment'), a game development company that shaped the history of video games with its characteristic graphical puzzles and logical storylines.

Williams' games taught logic and problem-solving skills camouflaged in

an adventure setting, drawing the player in like never before – similar to the way Foursquare or Swarm gamify seemingly routine travel or journeys into adventures filled with location check-ins, badge collections, mayorship earnings and so on.

Ars Technica has called Roberta Williams "one of the more iconic figures in adventure gaming", while GameSpot ranked her at #10 in its list of "The Most Influential People in Computer Gaming of all time" for "pushing the envelope of graphic adventures" and being "especially proactive in creating games from a woman's point of view, and titles that appealed to the mainstream market, all the while integrating the latest technologies in graphics and sound wherever possible."

Think about it for a second: If it weren't for Roberta Williams' genius, the world of video games would be a lot worse off than what it is currently.

APPLIED PHYSICS TO TECH

So far, we've read about women tech innovators who've either had a background in mathematics or engineering, but not pure physics. That changes with the introduction of Dr. Shirley Jackson, a theoretical physicist, who made a lasting impression in the evolution of several communication technologies.

The first African-American woman to get a PhD from MIT, Dr. Jackson



Robert Williams – 'One of the more iconic figures in adventure gaming.'